# UTTARAKHAND

## EMPOWERING THE MATRI SHAKTI

Women power has an important role in society, and one cannot imagine an ideal society without empowerment of the women. Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami is continuously trying to make Uttarakhand the leading state of the country by the year 2025. The date of 30 November this year was historic for Uttarakhand when two very important bills were passed during the supplementary budget session with voice vote. The Uttarakhand Public Services (Horizontal reservation for women) bill-2022 has paved way for the horizontal reservation of 30% for women in the state.

This is a great achievement for Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami government. State government is going to take another important step for women empowerment. Efforts are being made for drafting Uttarakhand State Women Policy. State Women Commission has prepared the initial draft of the policy in which emphasis has been given on social, economic and political upliftment of the women of the state.

In accordance with Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 'Beti Bachao-Beti Padhao' mega campaign, the Nanda Gaura scheme of the Uttarakhand government is also making women of the state stronger and self-reliant. The Government of Uttarakhand stood by with the girls of the state from their birth to their education and marriage. A total of 323 crore 22 lakh rupees has been deposited digitally through PFMS into the accounts of 80 thousand beneficiary girls under Nanda Gaura scheme from 2017-18 to year 2021-22. To make this scheme more effective the state government has made all the procedures online from this year so that the girls of the state should not run from pillar to post in government offices, and they can utilise time for their progress.

Women empowerment is only possible when women will feel safe in the society. In this direction, the work of the Uttarakhand Government is worth mentioning. Along with Mahila Mitra or women friend, Women Sub-Inspector is also being deployed in every police station of the state. This will help in fast settlement of complaints, and it will also encourage the woman to tell their problems without any hesitation. Government is strengthening the police help desk and helpline number 112. Women are being assured that the government is serious on the issue of their security. Feedback is also being taken from the complainant women.

To make things easy for working women, directions have been given to all departments to prepare an effective scheme. It has been directed also that the maternity leave of working